

FUNERALS

Chain-breakers 2017

- 1) A funeral is about 2 things –
Honoring the deceased and
ministering to the living
- 2) I always ask the family to give me
10-12 bullet points of things they
want the audience to know about
their loved one (What is in your
wallet)
- 3) I try to build a funeral sermon that
comforts the family and friends –
Honors the deceased – and convicts
the lost
- 4) Prepare the ending of your sermon
to include an altar call (My
experience with this)
- 5) I use the bullet points to weave into
a scripture text
- 6) Always rewrite the obituary to
where you are not just reading the
published version verbatim – For

instance – John Doe passed on
10/12/17... John Departed this life
to be in the presence of Jesus on
10/12/17...

- 7) Always phonetically spell the names of all family members – If you are not sure about a pronunciation ASK a family member – DO NOT WING IT
- 8) Never speak more than 20 -30 minutes at a funeral
- 9) After the sermon and final prayer, stand at the head of the casket and shake hands with everyone that comes by – Be sure to have a smile on your face as you greet the guests
- 10) Lead the casket from the pulpit to the hearse
- 11) Lead the casket from the hearse to the burial plot
- 12) Be prepared to call the graveside service to order by asking everyone to gather in as close as possible

- 13) Make sure your remarks are practical – but be sure to address the resurrection – (Example – This wife has lost a loving husband, these children have lost an awesome dad... Wait a minute! I don't think anyone has lost anything... This place seems so final – this is a comma in the middle of a sentence, not a period, exclamation point or question mark)
- 14) Never speak more than 5-10 minutes at the gravesite
- 15) When you are finished speaking remove your boutonnière and place it among the flowers on top of the casket
- 16) Shake hands with all immediate family seated under the tent, expressing your love and condolences